The Legislature

https://www.nysenate.gov/ https://nyassembly.gov/

The New York State Constitution vests the State's law-making power in a two-house Legislature composed of a 63-member Senate and a 150-member Assembly. Each representative is elected for two-year terms, with all 213 being elected every two years. The Legislature convenes annually on the first Wednesday after the first Monday in January and remains in session until it concludes its business. The Legislature has many powers set by Article III of the State Constitution. These include:

- ability to propose laws;
- ability to override a gubernatorial veto, if two-thirds of the Senate and Assembly vote to do so;
- fulfilling the requirements as set forth for reapportionment of legislative and congressional districts every ten years after the national census;
- confirmation by the Senate of gubernatorial appointments of non-elected state officials and court judges;
- proposition of amendments to the State Constitution;
- voting on ratification of proposed amendments to the Federal Constitution; and
- creation, regulation and, in some limited cases, abolition of local governments.

The Legislature's Budget authorizes funding for:

- Senate;
- Assembly;
- Independent Redistricting Commission;
- A portion of the Lieutenant Governor's office;
- Fiscal committee operations in each house of the Legislature; and
- Joint entities that serve both houses of the Legislature.

Legislative Budget Highlights

The recommended General Fund appropriation of $311,673,951 for FY 2026-27 for the Legislature, represents an increase of 3% or $9,077,882 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

The recommended appropriations for Special Revenue Fund-Other appropriation of $1,600,000 and for Grants and Bequests Funds of $500,000 for FY 2026-27 represent no changes from the amounts appropriated for FY 2025-26. No tax revenues are required for Special Revenue Funds, nor for Grants and Bequests Funds.

Lieutenant Governor

The Lieutenant Governor serves as the Senate's President and has a casting vote. Beginning January 1, 2021, the salary of the Lieutenant Governor is $220,000. Also, a portion of the operational expenses of the Lieutenant Governor's Office appear within the Legislative Budget.

Budget Highlights – Lieutenant Governor

The recommended appropriation of $361,869 for FY 2026-27 for the Lieutenant Governor represents an increase of 3% or $10,540 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

Senate

The New York State Senate is the Upper House of the New York State Legislature. It is composed of 63 Members elected to two-year terms. Each Senator represents approximately 312,000 constituents. The Senate conducts its legislative business by operating 46 Standing Committees, Commissions, and Task Forces.

The Senate elects, from among its Members, a President Pro Tempore and Majority Leader who administers the business of the Senate. Duties include the appointment of Members to Senate Standing Committees and Senate staff. The President Pro Tempore and Majority Leader presides over the Senate in the absence of the Lieutenant Governor and may delegate this duty to another Member. Each Conference of the Senate chooses a Leader from among its membership.

Budget Highlights – Senate

The FY 2026-2027 budget of $127,690,074 reflects a 3% increase or $3,719,128 from the amount appropriated in the FY 2025-2026 Enacted Budget. The FY 2026-27 Senate budget aligns priorities to address current inflationary increases. In addition, the Senate continues to generate cost savings by examining its internal processes and using those efficiencies to maximize our resources and improve the services provided to all 63 Senators and their constituents.

Assembly

The New York State Assembly is the Lower House of the New York State Legislature. It is composed of 150 members, from districts around the state, who are elected for two-year terms. Each Member of the Assembly represents approximately 131,000 constituents. The Assembly conducts its legislative business through the operation of 37 standing committees.

The Assembly elects, from among its Members, a Speaker who directs and guides the business of the Assembly and appoints members to Assembly Standing Committees and Assembly leadership positions. The Speaker serves as the presiding officer of the Assembly. The minority party of the Assembly chooses a Minority Leader from their membership.

Budget Highlights – Assembly

The recommended appropriation for FY 2026-27 of $148,338,779 represents an increase of 3% or $4,320,547 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26. Although the Assembly continues to control spending through operational efficiencies, this conservative 3% increase is necessary to keep up with rising costs, primarily driven by inflation.

Fiscal Committees

The Governor's annual budget bills and the budgetary proposals for the Legislature and Judiciary are referred to the fiscal committees of the Senate and the Assembly when introduced and are reported by them, with recommendations, to the Legislature. Designated representatives of the committees are constitutionally entitled to attend the required hearings for the preparation of the budget and to make inquiry concerning any part thereof. These committees also consider all bills introduced in the Legislature carrying appropriations or providing for State expenditures.

In addition, the Chairs and ranking Minority Members of the Senate Finance Committee and the Assembly Ways and Means Committee function as an Audit Committee, in order receive the results of each independent audit of the state's annual financial statements required pursuant to Section 8 of the State Finance Law.

Budget Highlights – Fiscal Committees

The recommended appropriation of $7,719,724 for FY 2026-27 for the Assembly Ways and Means Committee represents an increase of 3% or $224,846 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26. The Senate Finance Committee is funded as part of the Senate's total budget.

Joint Entities and Dues Payments

Legislative Ethics Commission

The Legislative Ethics Commission, established by Chapter 14 of the laws of 2007 and amended by Chapter 399 of the Laws of 2011, is a joint bipartisan commission comprised of four legislators and five non-legislative members. The Commission's duties, enumerated by Section 80 of the Legislative Law, include distribution, collection and review of financial disclosure statements from legislators, employees and candidates for legislative office, issuance of formal, binding, advisory opinions and adjudication of violations of Public Officers Law based upon substantial basis investigation reports received from the Joint Commission on Public Ethics. The Commission is also required to develop educational materials and ethics training in conjunction with and at the request of the Legislature, respond to informal requests for guidance, maintain a public website and prepare reports as required by statute.

Legislative Health Service

Section 7-b of the Legislative Law provides for a legislative emergency health station for the use of members and employees of the Legislature and legislative correspondents, to be staffed by a registered nurse and suitably and adequately equipped to administer first aid.

Legislative Library

Section 7-a of the Legislative Law provides for a Legislative Library to be located in the State Capitol, conveniently accessible to the members of both houses of the Legislature.

Legislative Messenger Service

The Legislative Messenger Service trains individuals with disabilities as messengers. These individuals provide a communications network throughout the Empire State Plaza and neighboring state buildings for Senate and Assembly legislators and their staffs.

Legislative Bill Drafting Commission

The Legislative Bill Drafting Commission is composed of two commissioners jointly appointed by the Temporary President of the Senate and the Speaker of the Assembly. The Commission drafts or aids in the drafting of legislative bills and resolutions, and may advise as to the constitutionality, consistency or effect of proposed legislation upon request of a member or committee of either house of the Legislature.

The Commission maintains and operates the Legislative Retrieval Service, a databank of New York State statutes, rules and regulations of state agencies. The Commission's budget covers the cost of staff, office leases, equipment and supplies, and the printing of legislative bills, session laws, Senate and Assembly Journals, and the Legislative Digest. The Commission receives revenues from the private sale of subscriptions to the Legislative Digest and to the Legislative Retrieval Service (LRS), which are deposited into the Legislative Computer Services Fund, a Special Revenue Fund, and used to offset the costs of operating the Commission's computer systems.

Legislative Task Force on Demographic Research and Reapportionment

The Task Force on Demographic Research and Reapportionment was established by Chapter 45 of the laws of 1978 and provides technical plans for meeting the Legislature’s responsibility for the reapportionment of Senate, Assembly and Congressional districts, subject to the requirements of the amendment to Article III of the State Constitution approved by the voters in November 2014. Using a Geographic Information System database, it also conducts research projects relating to the collection and use of census data and other statistical information. The Task Force revenues received from the sale of data and services are deposited in the Legislative Computer Services Fund and may be used to offset the Task Force’s costs.

National Conference of State Legislatures Dues

The National Conference of State Legislatures (NCSL) is a bi-partisan organization created to serve the legislators and staff of each State Legislature. NCSL provides research, technical assistance, a forum for discussion and information on developments in state-federal relations. All state legislators and their staff members are eligible to participate in the Conference, which is supported from dues assessed to each State Legislature based on state population totals.

Budget Highlights – Joint Entities

The recommended appropriation of $499,252 for FY 2026-27 for the Legislative Ethics Commission represents an increase of 3% or $14,541 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

The recommended appropriation of $492,075 for FY 2026-27 for the National Conference of State Legislatures dues represents an increase of 3% or $14,332 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

The recommended appropriation of $278,371 for FY 2026-27 for the Legislative Health Service represents an increase of 3% or $8,108 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

The recommended appropriation of $1,051,762 for FY 2026-27 for the Legislative Library represents an increase of 3% or $30,634 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

The recommended appropriation of $1,196,186 for FY 2026-27 for the Legislative Messenger Service represents an increase of 3% or $34,841 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

The recommended appropriation of $20,451,710 for FY 2026-27 for the Legislative Bill Drafting Commission represents an increase of 3% or $595,681 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

The recommended appropriation of $2,430,249 for FY 2026-27 for the Legislative Task Force on Demographic Research and Reapportionment represents an increase of 3% or $70,784 from the amount appropriated in FY 2025-26.

The recommended appropriation of $1,500,000 for FY 2026-27 for the Legislative Computer Services Fund represents no change from the amount appropriated for FY 2025-26. No tax revenues are required for this Fund.

ALL FUNDS REQUIREMENTS FOR THE LEGISLATURE

FUND/ENTITY/MAJOR PURPOSE	APPROPRIATION 2025-26	REQUESTED 2026-27	CHANGE FROM PRIOR YEAR
General Fund:			
Lt. Governor	**351,329**	**361,869**	**10,540**
Senate	**123,970,946**	**127,690,074**	**3,719,128**
Assembly	**144,018,232**	**148,338,779**	**4,320,547**
Assembly Ways and Means Committee	**7,494,878**	**7,719,724**	**224,846**
Independent Redistricting Commission	**1,130,000**	**1,163,900**	**33,900**
Joint Entities:			
Legislative Ethics Commission	484,711	499,252	14,541
National Conference of State Legislatures Dues	477,743	492,075	14,332
Legislative Health Service	270,263	278,371	8,108
Legislative Library	1,021,128	1,051,762	30,634
Legislative Messenger Service	1,161,345	1,196,186	34,841
Legislative Bill Drafting Commission	19,856,029	20,451,710	595,681
Legislative Task Force on Demographic Research & Reapportionment	2,359,465	2,430,249	70,784
Joint Entities Total	**25,630,684**	**26,399,605**	**768,921**
GENERAL FUND TOTAL	**302,596,069**	**311,673,951**	**9,077,882**
Special Revenue Fund - Other:			
Legislative Computer Services Fund	1,500,000	1,500,000	0
Senate Recyclable Materials, Information Services and Conference Fund	50,000	50,000	0
Assembly Recyclable Materials, Information Services and Conference Fund	50,000	50,000	0
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND TOTAL	**1,600,000**	**1,600,000**	**0**
Grants and Bequests Fund:			
Restoration of Senate Chamber	250,000	250,000	0
Restoration of Assembly Chamber	250,000	250,000	0
GRANTS AND BEQUESTS FUND TOTAL	**500,000**	**500,000**	**0**

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
OFFICE OF THE LIEUTENANT GOVERNOR			
Administration Program--Personal Service			
For personal service of employees and for temporary and expert services:			
Personal Service Regular	$336,694	$347,234	$10,540
Administration Program--Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and materials	$14,635	$14,635	$0
Total--Office of Lieutenant Governor	**$351,329**	**$361,869**	**$10,540**
THE SENATE			
Personal Service			
For payment of salaries to members, 63, pursuant to section five of the legislative law	$8,946,000	$8,946,000	$0
For payment of allowances to members designated by the temporary president, pursuant to the schedule of such allowances set forth in section 5-a of the legislative law	$1,289,500	$1,289,500	$0
For personal service of employees and for temporary and expert services of members' offices and of standing committees:			
Personal Service Regular	$44,476,284	$46,168,354	$1,692,070
For personal service of employees and for temporary and expert services for senate operations:			
Personal Service Regular	$42,612,932	$44,328,609	$1,715,677
For personal service of employees and for temporary and expert services for the senate student program office:			
Personal Service Regular	$410,556	$489,128	$78,572
Temporary Service	$1,134,716	$1,367,525	$232,809

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
Total Personal Service	$98,869,988	$102,589,116	$3,719,128
Nonpersonal Service			
For services and expenses of maintenance and operations (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026):			
Supplies and materials	$6,365,595	$6,365,595	$0
Travel	$1,554,141	$1,554,141	$0
Miscellaneous contractual services, including, but not limited to, childcare expenses incurred by members of the New York State Senate in the execution of their duties of public office	$14,557,989	$14,557,989	$0
Equipment	$2,623,233	$2,623,233	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$25,100,958	$25,100,958	$0
Grand Total--The Senate	**$123,970,946**	**$127,690,074**	**$3,719,128**
THE ASSEMBLY			
Personal Service			
Members, 150, payment of salaries pursuant to section five of the legislative law	$21,300,000	$21,300,000	$0
For payment of allowances to members designated by the speaker pursuant to the provisions of section 5-a of the legislative law	$1,592,500	$1,592,500	$0
For personal service of employees and for temporary and expert services of members' offices and of standing committees and subcommittees:			
Personal Service Regular	$35,500,000	$36,000,000	$500,000
Temporary Service	$2,500,000	$3,000,000	$500,000
For personal service of employees and for temporary and expert services for administrative and program support operations:			

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
Personal Service Regular	$43,300,732	$44,046,279	$745,547
Temporary Service	$500,000	$600,000	$100,000
For the Assembly Intern and Youth Participation Program for personal service of employees and for temporary and expert services:			
Personal Service Regular	$425,000	$400,000	($25,000)
Temporary Service	$1,400,000	$1,400,000	$0
Total Personal Service	$106,518,232	$108,338,779	$1,820,547
Nonpersonal Service			
For services and expenses of maintenance and operations (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026):			
Supplies and Materials	$4,000,000	$4,500,000	$500,000
Travel	$3,500,000	$3,500,000	$0
Miscellaneous contractual services	$25,000,000	$25,500,000	$500,000
Equipment	$5,000,000	$6,500,000	$1,500,000
Total Nonpersonal Service	$37,500,000	$40,000,000	$2,500,000
Grand Total--The Assembly	**$144,018,232**	**$148,338,779**	**$4,320,547**

ASSEMBLY WAYS & MEANS COMMITTEE

Personal Service			
For personal service, temporary and special services (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026):			
Personal Service Regular	$6,809,878	$6,934,724	$124,846
Temporary Service	$120,000	$120,000	$0
Total Personal Service	$6,929,878	7,054,724	$124,846

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$350,000	$350,000	$0
Travel	$5,000	$5,000	$0
Contractual Services	$200,000	$300,000	$100,000
Equipment	$10,000	$10,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$565,000	$665,000	$100,000
Total--Assembly Ways & Means Committee	**$7,494,878**	**$7,719,724**	**$224,846**

INDEPENDENT REDISTRICTING COMMISSION

Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$600,000	$633,900	$33,900
Total Personal Service	$600,000	$633,900	$33,900
Nonpersonal Service			
For services and expenses (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026) of the Independent Redistricting Commission			
Supplies and Materials	$10,000	$10,000	$0
Travel	$10,000	$10,000	$0
Contractual Services	$500,000	$500,000	$0
Equipment	$10,000	$10,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$530,000	$530,000	$0
Total—Independent Redistricting Commission	**$1,130,000**	**$1,163,900**	**$33,900**

SENATE AND ASSEMBLY JOINT ENTITIES

LEGISLATIVE ETHICS COMMISSION

For services and expenses of the legislative ethics commission pursuant to section 80 of the legislative law (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026):

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$466,544	$481,085	$14,541
Total Personal Service	$466,544	$481,085	$14,541
Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$1,667	$1,667	$0
Travel	$15,000	$15,000	$0
Contractual Services	$1,000	$1,000	$0
Equipment	$500	$500	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$18,167	$18,167	$0
Total--Legislative Ethics Commission	**$484,711**	**$499,252**	**$14,541**

NATIONAL CONFERENCE OF STATE LEGISLATURES

For a contribution to the National Conference of State Legislatures:			
Contractual Services	$477,743	$492,075	$14,332
Total--National Conference of State Legislatures	**$477,743**	**$492,075**	**$14,332**

LEGISLATIVE HEALTH SERVICE

For services and expenses for the operation of the legislative health service (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026):			
Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$242,563	$250,671	$8,108
Total Personal Service	$242,563	$250,671	$8,108
Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$25,700	$25,700	$0

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
Contractual Services	$1,000	$1,000	$0
Equipment	$1,000	$1,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$27,700	$27,700	$0
Total--Legislative Health Service	**$270,263**	**$278,371**	**$8,108**

LEGISLATIVE LIBRARY

For services and expenses for the operation of the legislative library (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026):

Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$642,128	$672,762	$30,634
Total Personal Service	$642,128	$672,762	$30,634
Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$100,000	$100,000	$0
Contractual Services	$274,000	$274,000	$0
Equipment	$5,000	$5,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$379,000	$379,000	$0
Total--Legislative Library	**$1,021,128**	**$1,051,762**	**$30,634**

LEGISLATIVE MESSENGER SERVICE

For services and expenses for the operation of the legislative messenger service (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026):

Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$1,159,345	$1,194,186	$34,841
Total Personal Service	$1,159,345	$1,194,186	$34,841
Nonpersonal Service			

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
Supplies and Materials	$2,000	$2,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$2,000	$2,000	$0
Total--Legislative Messenger Service	**$1,161,345**	**$1,196,186**	**$34,841**

LEGISLATIVE BILL DRAFTING COMMISSION

For services and expenses, temporary and special services, and for expenses of maintenance and operation			
Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$14,435,235	$15,030,916	$595,681
Temporary Service	$169,240	$169,240	$0
Total Personal Service	$14,604,475	$15,200,156	$595,681
Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$332,021	$332,021	$0
Travel	$50,577	$50,577	$0
Contractual Services	$4,710,163	$4,710,163	$0
Equipment	$158,793	$158,793	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$5,251,554	$5,251,554	$0
Total--Legislative Bill Drafting Commission	**$19,856,029**	**$20,451,710**	**$595,681**

LEG. TASK FORCE ON DEMOGRAPHIC RESEARCH AND REAPPORTIONMENT

For services and expenses (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026) of the task force for senate purposes			
Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$447,987	$461,739	$13,752
Total Personal Service	$447,987	$461,739	$13,752
Nonpersonal Service			

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
Travel	$3,000	$3,000	$0
Contractual Services	$7,402	$7,402	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$10,402	$10,402	$0
Total—Senate	**$458,389**	**$472,141**	**$13,752**
For services and expenses (including liabilities incurred prior to April 1, 2026) of the task force for assembly purposes			
Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$442,803	$456,423	$13,620
Total Personal Service	$442,803	$456,423	$13,620
Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$1,000	$1,000	$0
Travel	$1,000	$1,000	$0
Contractual Services	$7,200	$7,200	$0
Equipment	$2,000	$2,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$11,200	$11,200	$0
Total—Assembly	**$454,003**	**$467,623**	**$13,620**
For services and expenses (including liabilities incurred Prior to April 1, 2026) of the task force for joint purposes			
Personal Service			
Personal Service Regular	$1,111,073	$1,154,485	$43,412
Total Personal Service	$1,111,073	$1,154,485	$43,412
Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$17,000	$17,000	$0
Travel	$5,000	$5,000	$0
Contractual Services	$106,000	$106,000	$0
Equipment	$208,000	$208,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$336,000	$336,000	$0

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
Total--Joint Operations	**$1,447,073**	**$1,490,485**	**$43,412**
Total--Task Force on Demographic Research and Reapportionment	**$2,359,465**	**$2,430,249**	**$70,784**
Grand Total--Senate and Assembly Joint Entities	**$25,630,684**	**$26,399,605**	**$768,921**

SPECIAL REVENUE FUND - OTHER

LEGISLATIVE COMPUTER SERVICES FUND

For services and expenses of the legislative computer services fund

Nonpersonal Service			
Contractual Services	$1,000,000	$1,000,000	$0
Equipment	$500,000	$500,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$1,500,000	$1,500,000	$0
Total--Legislative Computer Services Fund	**$1,500,000**	**$1,500,000**	**$0**

SENATE RECYCLABLE MATERIALS, INFORMATION SERVICES AND CONFERENCE FUND

For services and expenses of the senate recyclable materials, information services and conference fund

Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$50,000	$50,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$50,000	$50,000	$0
Total--Senate Recyclable Materials, Information Services and Conference Fund	**$50,000**	**$50,000**	**$0**

Title of Appropriation	Appropriated for 2025-26	Requested for 2026-27	Change
ASSEMBLY RECYCLABLE MATERIALS, INFORMATION SERVICES AND CONFERENCE FUND			
For services and expenses of the assembly recyclable materials, information services and conference fund			
Nonpersonal Service			
Supplies and Materials	$50,000	$50,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$50,000	$50,000	$0
Total--Assembly Recyclable Materials, Information Services and Conference Fund	**$50,000**	**$50,000**	**$0**
GRANTS AND BEQUESTS FUND – LEGISLATURE			
SENATE			
For services and expenses relative to restoration of the Senate Chamber and other purposes as funded by non-state grants			
Nonpersonal Service			
Contractual Services	$250,000	$250,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$250,000	$250,000	$0
Total--Senate Grants and Bequests Fund	**$250,000**	**$250,000**	**$0**
ASSEMBLY			
For services and expenses relative to restoration of the Assembly Chamber and other purposes as funded by non-state grants			
Nonpersonal Service			
Contractual Services	$250,000	$250,000	$0
Total Nonpersonal Service	$250,000	$250,000	$0
Total--Assembly Grants and Bequests Fund	**$250,000**	**$250,000**	**$0**